

Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 7

A clamshell foldable vibe

Foldable phones are not rare anymore, but they still manage to stand out, and Samsung knows this. With the Flip 7, Samsung has made just enough changes to keep things interesting, some smart and some questionable. There is a new chip (it has its own story), a better and brighter display, and a few AI tricks. However, at its core, it still feels like the Flip you have seen before, until you grab it and start using it. So, is this the year the Galaxy Z Flip 7 becomes more than just a vibe? Can you finally trust it as your main phone and not just a conversation starter? I've been using the Flip 7 for a while now, and here's everything that worked for me... and what didn't.

LIGHTER, SLEEKER, AND BETTER!

At first glance, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip 7 might look like its predecessor, but hold on. The first change that you would notice now is that the cover display goes end-to-end. Unlike the Galaxy Z Flip 6, where the display stopped right around the cameras, this display incorporates the cameras too. The cover display or FlexWindow has been increased to 4.1 inches, from the previous 3.4 inches. You can use that for some cool wallpaper tricks, as I saw fellow tech journalists do on Instagram.

It retains the same sleek folding design, the same compact clamshell aesthetic, aluminium frames and that nostalgic flip action that never gets old.

But look closer, and the refinements become apparent. The phone now has a slightly slimmer hinge and thinner bezels around the main display. It weighs less, just 188g, and it effectively feels so if you have used its predecessor. When unfolded, the phone is just 6.55mm thick and folded, which makes it the thinnest

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clamshell foldable in India. As far as the form factor is concerned, Samsung has really made this device quite comfortable to carry around. Be it small pockets, hands, or bags, it can fit anywhere.

The phone also feels more sturdy, and the hinge is pretty solid. But how we used to open old clamshell foldable phones with one hand, it is still not possible with this one. This is something that I personally want on these foldable phones because many times you're in a situation where you can't use both your hands.

What was once a concern has now become normal. We have also tested the Motorola Razr 60 Ultra (review), Flip 7's direct competitor, and one thing I really like about these clamshells is that they unfold completely and remain flat. But the new objective is to fix hinge gaps now. When folded, the Galaxy Z Flip 7 has no hinge gap; it closes completely. Whereas, the Razr 60 Ultra does leave that awkward gap when folded.

DISPLAY'S A BANGER, BUT LET IT DO MORE SAMSUNG!

As I mentioned earlier, the cover display has been increased to 4.1 inches this

year. Even the bezels are barely visible this time around. It is an AMOLED display with up to 120Hz refresh rate and a claimed peak brightness of 2600 nits. On our tests, the display reached a maximum brightness of 2380 nits, which is still pretty good. This display is sharp, smooth, and vibrant. But, how OneUI 8 makes this display charming with all those animations and interfaces, the same way it makes this display less usable also.

Even after 6 generations, you still can't fully access all of the apps on Samsung's clamshell foldables' cover display. There are still only widgets you get to use on this display, and the camera. But, there is a third-party way. You can use the Good Lock app to enable certain apps, but that's also limited. Whereas, the Razr 60 Ultra gives you so much access that you can even run benchmarks on its outer display. Now, before you think, 'who would want to do all of that on cover displays,' maybe I would. Remember that 'using the phone with one hand problem?' More accessibility on the outer display can fix that.

Here's what you can do with this 4.1-inch display. With Galaxy AI built in, you can now reply to messages, use apps like YouTube, Maps, and Messages, and even customise the cover screen with widgets, live wallpapers, and AI-generated wallpapers. Is it enough to do most tasks without unfolding the phone? Almost. It's perfect for quick replies, skipping songs, checking notifications, and even taking selfies using the rear cameras.

When unfolded, you get a 6.9-inch main display, an improvement over the 6.7-inch display from last year. Again, it's a FHD+ LTPO AMOLED panel with 120Hz refresh rate, HDR 10+ support, and a claimed peak brightness of 2600 nits. On our tests, the phone reached a max brightness of 2610 nits, so clearly no issues on the brightness front.

Visually, it is a premium Samsung display on a flagship Samsung phone. I don't think I really have to make a case here. The display is visually beautiful, fluid, the blacks and whites are on point, and with this size, you will really enjoy watching content on it.